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What the Google Ads API lets PPCWay do

Every part of the Google Ads API that becomes available once the developer token is raised to **Basic** or **Standard** access, written out in full and sorted into two plain groups: the calls that only **look** at an account, and the calls that **change** something in it.

The distinction matters more than any technical detail in this document. Reading an account is how an audit is produced. Changing one is how money gets spent. PPCWay does the first today, and will only ever do the second with the account owner's explicit approval of the specific change, recorded before it is applied.

Google Cloud project	`ppcway-509313` · number `734687676224`
API version in use	v25, the current release
Permission requested	`https://www.googleapis.com/auth/adwords`, granted by the account owner
What PPCWay calls today	Five read queries. Nothing that changes an account.

Every endpoint, limit and restriction in this document is taken from Google's own published reference for the Google Ads API, October 2026. Where a number is quoted, it is Google's number.

How to read this document

The Google Ads API is not a long list of web addresses, the way most APIs are. It has a very small number of addresses and a very large number of things you can ask for at each one. Three facts make the rest of this document straightforward.

1. There is one address for reading, and it answers hundreds of questions

Everything an account can tell you — spend, clicks, keywords, search terms, ads, policy decisions, settings, history — comes back from a single endpoint:

`POST /v25/customers/{customerId}/googleAds:search`

You send it a query written in Google Ads Query Language, naming which *resource* you want (for example `search_term_view`) and which fields of it. So the list of "read endpoints" in this document is really a list of resources you can ask that one endpoint about. None of them can alter anything; a query is a question.

2. Changing something is a different kind of call, and is named plainly

Each kind of thing you can change has its own address ending in `:mutate`, and each one accepts exactly three operations: **create**, **update** and **remove**.

`POST /v25/customers/{customerId}/campaignBudgets:mutate`

There is no way to change an account by accident through a read call, and no way to read through a mutate call. The two are separate by design, which is what makes the promise in this document checkable rather than rhetorical.

3. The access level decides which services are allowed, not which reports

Raising the token to Basic does not unlock extra reports. Every report listed in the next section is available at any level — against test accounts at Test level, and against real accounts from Explorer upwards. What the level governs is the daily volume, and whether a handful of sensitive services may be called at all.

The four access levels, in Google's own numbers

LEVEL	ACCOUNTS IT MAY READ	DAILY LIMIT	WHAT IS HELD BACK
Test where the token is today	Test accounts only. Real accounts are refused outright.	15,000 operations a day	All production data. This is why PPCWay cannot read a live account yet.
Explorer	Test and real accounts	2,880 a day on real accounts; 15,000 on test accounts	Account creation, user management, the planning tools, and billing services
Basic what we are asking for	Test and real accounts	15,000 a day on both	Nothing from the list above. Brand verification is required to be granted it.
Standard	Test and real accounts	Unlimited	Nothing, though individual services keep their own rate limits. Granted after a manual audit, for larger tools.

What one "operation" means. A whole report counts as one operation, however many rows come back: Google states that a `Search` or `SearchStream` request "counts as one operation… irrespective of the number of batches". Changes are counted one by one instead — editing forty keywords is forty operations.

So a PPCWay audit, which runs five reports, spends five of the day's allowance per merchant. At Basic access that is roughly three thousand audits a day before the limit is anywhere in sight.

Part one — VIEW ONLY reading an account

Nothing in this part can alter an account. Every item below is a report requested through `googleAds:search`. They are the same reports the account owner sees in the Google Ads interface, read programmatically instead of by eye.

The reading endpoints themselves

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT DOES
`googleAds:search`	Runs one query and returns the matching rows, a page at a time. This is the endpoint behind every report in this section. **PPCWay uses this one.**
`googleAds:searchStream`	The same thing, streamed in one continuous response rather than paged. Faster for large reports; identical data.
`customers:listAccessibleCustomers`	Lists which accounts the granted permission reaches. No account data, just the numbers. **PPCWay uses this** so the owner can choose which account we read.
`googleAdsFields:search`	Asks the API to describe itself: which fields exist on which report. Documentation, not account data.

Account, structure and settings

How the account is put together. No performance figures, just what exists and how it is configured.

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`customer`	The account itself: its name, currency, time zone, whether it is a manager account, and whether auto-tagging is on. **PPCWay reads this** to label the report with the right currency.
`customer_client`	Every account sitting beneath a manager account, and the hierarchy between them.
`campaign`	Each campaign: its name, type, status, start and end dates, networks, bidding strategy and budget.
`campaign_budget`	The daily budget behind each campaign, whether it is shared, and how it is delivered.
`campaign_group`	Campaigns grouped together for shared budgeting and reporting.
`ad_group`	Each ad group inside a campaign, with its status and default bid.

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`bidding_strategy` · `accessible_bidding_strategy`	Portfolio bidding strategies and their targets, including ones shared from a manager account.
`campaign_criterion` · `ad_group_criterion`	Everything being targeted or excluded: keywords, negative keywords, locations, languages, devices, audiences, schedules.
`shared_set` · `shared_criterion` · `campaign_shared_set`	Shared negative keyword and placement lists, and which campaigns use them.
`label` · `campaign_label` · `ad_group_label`	The labels an account uses to organise itself.
`experiment` · `experiment_arm`	Campaign experiments and A/B tests, and how each arm is performing.
`campaign_bid_modifier` · `ad_group_bid_modifier`	Bid adjustments by device, location, schedule or audience.

Money and performance

Spend and what it bought. These figures are available on almost every report above, segmented by date, device, network and more.

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`customer` with metrics	The account's cost, clicks, impressions and conversions over any date range. **PPCWay reads this** for "you spent X in the last thirty days".
`campaign` with metrics	The same, per campaign, plus impression share: the proportion of available searches the ads actually appeared on, and how much was lost to a small budget as opposed to a low ad rank. **PPCWay reads this** for the budget check.
`ad_group` with metrics	Spend and results one level down, which is usually where waste is visible.
`click_view`	Individual clicks, with their Google Click ID, for the last ninety days.
`shopping_performance_view` · `shopping_product` · `product_group_view`	Retail performance by product, brand, category and custom label.
`video` · `video_enhancement`	Video ad performance: views, view rate, watch-through quartiles.
`hotel_performance_view` · `hotel_group_view` · `travel_activity_performance_view`	Travel and hospitality reporting, for accounts that run those campaign types.
`per_store_view` · `distance_view`	Performance by shop location, and by how far the searcher was from it.
`cart_data_sales_view`	Sales figures sent back from a shop's basket, where that is connected.

What people actually typed into Google

The most valuable reading in the whole API for a small business, and the one an owner almost never looks at.

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`search_term_view`	Every real search that triggered an ad, with what it cost and whether it led to an enquiry. **PPCWay reads this** to show the searches that took money and brought nothing back.
`campaign_search_term_view`	The same at campaign level, including campaign types where terms are not tied to a keyword.
`customer_search_term_insight` · `campaign_search_term_insight`	Google's own grouping of searches into themes, which is useful when the raw list runs to thousands of rows.
`dynamic_search_ads_search_term_view`	Searches matched by dynamic ads, where Google chose the landing page itself.
`smart_campaign_search_term_view`	The equivalent for Smart campaigns, which is what many small businesses are sold first.
`paid_organic_search_term_view`	Paid and unpaid results for the same search side by side — whether you are paying for clicks you were already getting free.
`ai_max_search_term_ad_combination_view`	Search terms matched to automatically generated ad combinations.

Keywords and quality

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`keyword_view`	Each keyword with its spend, its results and its **Quality Score** out of ten, plus Google's judgement of the expected click rate, ad relevance and landing page experience behind that score. **PPCWay reads this**: a low score means paying more than a competitor for the identical click.
`display_keyword_view` · `topic_view` · `content_criterion_view`	What display ads were shown against: keywords, topics and content categories.
`webpage_view`	Which pages of the website dynamic ads sent people to.
`managed_placement_view` · `detail_placement_view` · `group_placement_view`	The specific websites, apps and videos ads appeared on.
`performance_max_placement_view`	Where Performance Max placed the ads, which is otherwise invisible.

Ads, assets and policy

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`ad_group_ad`	Every ad, its text, its status and — the part that matters — its **policy summary**: whether Google has approved it, approved it with limits, or disapproved it entirely. **PPCWay reads this**, because a disapproved ad spends nothing and is rarely noticed.
`ad_group_ad_asset_view` · `ad_group_ad_asset_combination_view`	Which headlines and descriptions Google is actually choosing to show, and how each performs.
`asset` · `asset_field_type_view` · `asset_set_asset`	Images, logos, videos, sitelinks, callouts, call and location extensions, with performance for each.
`asset_group` · `asset_group_asset` · `asset_group_product_group_view`	The structure of Performance Max campaigns.
`campaign_asset` · `ad_group_asset` · `customer_asset`	Which extensions are attached at which level.
`final_url_expansion_asset_view`	Pages Google chose to advertise on its own initiative.

Who saw the ads, and where

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`geographic_view` · `user_location_view`	Where the people searching actually were, as against where the campaign thought it was targeting.
`location_view` · `location_interest_view` · `matched_location_interest_view`	Targeted locations, and places people were merely interested in.
`age_range_view` · `gender_view` · `parental_status_view` · `income_range_view`	Performance by demographic, where Google can determine it.
`campaign_audience_view` · `ad_group_audience_view` · `audience`	Audience segments in use and how each performs.
`user_list` · `custom_audience` · `combined_audience`	Remarketing lists and custom audiences defined in the account.
`ad_schedule_view`	Performance by day of the week and hour of the day.

Conversions and tracking

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`conversion_action`	What the account counts as a result — a call, a form, a purchase — how each is counted and what it is valued at. Often the first thing an audit finds missing.
`conversion_value_rule` · `conversion_custom_variable`	Rules that adjust the value of a conversion, and any custom data attached to it.
`campaign_conversion_goal` · `customer_conversion_goal`	Which conversions each campaign is actually optimising towards.
`call_view`	Calls from call-only ads and call extensions: duration, status, and whether each was counted.
`landing_page_view` · `expanded_landing_page_view`	Performance by landing page, including Google's mobile-friendliness judgement.

Account health and history

REPORT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`recommendation`	Google's own suggestions for the account, and the optimisation score attached to them. Reading them is not the same as applying them; applying is in part two.
`change_event` · `change_status`	Who changed what, and when, for the last thirty days. This is also how an owner can audit anything PPCWay ever does.
`billing_setup` · `account_budget` · `invoice`	Billing arrangements, account-level budgets and invoices. *Restricted below Basic access.*
`customer_user_access` · `customer_user_access_invitation`	Who has access to the account and at what level. *Restricted below Basic access.*
`customer_client_link` · `customer_manager_link`	Links between manager and client accounts.
`product_link` · `data_link` · `third_party_app_analytics_link`	Connections to Merchant Center, YouTube, Google Analytics and similar.
`local_services_lead` · `local_services_verification_artifact`	Leads and verification state for Local Services Ads.

> **This is not quite the complete list.** Google publishes more than a hundred and seventy reportable resources, including several for campaign types a small business will never run. Everything above covers what an audit or an optimisation service would ever sensibly read; the full reference is published at `developers.google.com/google-ads/api/fields/v25/overview`.

Part two — CHANGES THE ACCOUNT writing to it

Everything in this part alters a live advertising account, and most of it can affect spending within minutes. PPCWay calls none of it today. When that changes, no call in this part will ever be made without the account owner approving that specific change first, and every one of them will be written to an append-only record before it is applied, so that what was changed, when, and on whose authority can always be answered.

How a change is made

Each address below accepts a list of operations, and each operation is one of three things: **create** something new, **update** something that exists (naming exactly which fields may change), or **remove** it. Google permits up to 10,000 operations in a single request, or 20,000 for ad group criteria, and offers a "partial failure" mode in which valid operations proceed and invalid ones are reported back rather than taking the whole request down.

Budgets and bidding — the controls that move money fastest

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`campaignBudgets:mutate`	The daily budget of a campaign. The single most consequential call in the API: raise it and spending rises the same day.
`biddingStrategies:mutate`	How Google bids — manual, maximise clicks, target cost per action, target return on spend — and the targets set for each.
`campaignBidModifiers:mutate` · `adGroupBidModifiers:mutate`	Bid adjustments by device, location, time of day or audience, such as bidding less on desktops.
`biddingSeasonalityAdjustments:mutate` · `biddingDataExclusions:mutate`	Tells the bidding system to expect an unusual period, or to disregard one it has already seen.

Campaigns

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`campaigns:mutate`	Creates, pauses, resumes, renames or removes a campaign, and sets its dates, networks and targeting expansion.
`campaignCriteria:mutate`	What a campaign targets or excludes: locations, languages, devices, audiences, negative keywords, schedules.
`campaignAssets:mutate` · `campaignAssetSets:mutate`	Attaches or removes sitelinks, callouts, call buttons and similar at campaign level.
`campaignGroups:mutate` · `campaignLabels:mutate`	Grouping and labelling, which change organisation rather than delivery.
`campaignConversionGoals:mutate` · `customerConversionGoals:mutate`	Which conversions a campaign is told to optimise towards.
`campaignSharedSets:mutate`	Applies or detaches a shared negative keyword list.

Ad groups and keywords

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`adGroups:mutate`	Creates, pauses or removes ad groups and sets their default bids.
`adGroupCriteria:mutate`	The workhorse: adds keywords, changes match types, sets individual bids, and — most usefully for an audit — **adds negative keywords** so that wasteful searches stop costing money.
`adGroupCriterionCustomizers:mutate` · `adGroupCriterionLabels:mutate`	Customised ad text per keyword, and labelling.
`sharedSets:mutate` · `sharedCriteria:mutate`	Builds negative keyword and placement lists that several campaigns can share.

Ads and creative

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`adGroupAds:mutate`	Creates, pauses or removes ads, and is how a disapproved ad is replaced.
`ads:mutate`	Edits the text or final URL of an existing ad.
`assets:mutate` · `assetSets:mutate` · `assetSetAssets:mutate`	Uploads and organises images, logos, videos, sitelinks and callouts.
`assetGroups:mutate` · `assetGroupAssets:mutate`	Builds and edits Performance Max campaigns.
`customerAssets:mutate` · `adGroupAssets:mutate`	Attaches extensions at account or ad group level.

Conversions and measurement

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`conversionActions:mutate`	Creates and configures what counts as a result, and what it is worth. This is how an account with no tracking is given some.
`conversionValueRules:mutate` · `conversionCustomVariables:mutate`	Adjusts conversion values by location, device or audience.
`conversionUploads:uploadClickConversions` · `:uploadCallConversions`	Sends offline results back to Google — a job won weeks after the click — so bidding learns from what actually happened.
`conversionAdjustmentUploads:uploadConversionAdjustments`	Corrects or retracts a conversion already reported.
`customerConversionGoals:mutate`	Sets which conversions matter account-wide.

Audiences and customer data

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`userLists:mutate` · `audiences:mutate` · `customAudiences:mutate`	Creates remarketing lists and audience definitions.
`offlineUserDataJobs:create` · `:addOperations` · `:run`	Uploads customer lists for matching. Handled carefully: it carries personal data and has its own consent requirements.
`userDataService:uploadUserData`	The same for smaller, immediate uploads.

Experiments and recommendations

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`experiments:mutate` · `experimentArms:mutate` · `experiments:scheduleExperiment`	Sets up a controlled test of a change against the existing setup, and promotes the winner. The safest way to make a significant change.
`recommendations:apply`	Applies one of Google's own suggestions. Powerful and blunt: several of its suggestions raise spending, which is why it is never applied automatically.
`recommendations:dismiss` · `recommendationSubscriptions:mutate`	Dismisses a suggestion, or subscribes the account to apply a category of them automatically.

Account administration — restricted below Basic access

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT CHANGES
`customers:createCustomerClient`	Creates a brand new Google Ads account under a manager account. Useful for onboarding a business that has none.
`customers:mutate`	Account-level settings: name, auto-tagging, call reporting, conversion tracking arrangements.
`customerUserAccess:mutate` · `customerUserAccessInvitations:mutate`	Grants or revokes a person's access to an account.
`customerClientLinks:mutate` · `customerManagerLinks:mutate`	Links an account to a manager account, or unlinks it.
`billingSetups:mutate` · `accountBudgetProposals:mutate`	Payment arrangements and account-level budgets.
`batchJobs:mutate` · `:addOperations` · `:run`	Runs very large sets of changes in the background rather than all at once.

Part three — PLANNING estimates and forecasts

These answer "what would happen if", using Google's own market data. They change nothing, but Google classes them separately because they expose commercially valuable data: they are **blocked below Basic access**, and rate limited even above it.

ENDPOINT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
`keywordPlanIdeas:generateKeywordIdeas`	Keyword suggestions from a word, a website or a page, each with search volume, competition and what the top of the page costs. **This is what turns "you are missing searches" into "about 1,900 people a month search for this here".**
`keywordPlanIdeas:generateKeywordHistoricalMetrics`	Monthly search volume and bid ranges for up to 10,000 keywords you already have.
`keywordPlanIdeas:generateKeywordForecastMetrics`	Projected clicks, cost and conversions for a proposed setup, up to a year ahead.
`keywordPlanIdeas:generateAdGroupThemes`	Groups keywords into sensible ad groups with suggested match types.
`keywordPlans:generateForecastCurve` · `:generateForecastTimeSeries`	How results would change at different budgets — the honest answer to "what would another hundred a month buy me?".
`reachPlans:generateReachForecast`	Audience reach and frequency forecasts for video campaigns.
`audienceInsights:generateInsightsFinderReport`	What a given audience is interested in, for targeting decisions.

> **Why this part matters to the product.** Without it, PPCWay can tell a business what is wrong. With it, PPCWay can tell them what it is worth in pounds and pence — which is the difference between a report that is read and a report that is acted on.

What PPCWay calls today

The whole audit, as deployed, is five read queries and one listing call per merchant. Every one of them is in part one.

QUERY	WHAT THE MERCHANT IS SHOWN
`customer`	"You spent $47.18 on Google Ads in the last thirty days. That bought 603 clicks at $0.08 each."
`search_term_view`	"$7.00 went to searches that brought no enquiry", with the searches listed.

QUERY	WHAT THE MERCHANT IS SHOWN
`keyword_view`	"Google scores four of your keywords at five or less, and they took $12.40."
`campaign`	"Emergency plumbing missed 34% of its searches because the budget ran out."
`ad_group_ad`	"Two of your ads are disapproved, so they are not being shown at all."
`customers:listAccessibleCustomers`	Lets the owner choose which of their accounts we read.

That is six operations out of a daily allowance of fifteen thousand. The request for Basic access is not about volume; it is simply that at Test level Google refuses all six against a real account.

What PPCWay promises about part two

- **Nothing is changed without a specific yes.** Not a category of changes agreed once, but the individual change, described in plain words, approved before it happens.
- **Everything is written down before it is applied.** Every automated change goes to an append-only record first — what, when, why, and on whose authority — and that record is the merchant's to read.
- **Every change passes a fixed set of safety checks** in a fixed order before it reaches Google, including limits on how far a budget may move.
- **One door.** A single service in the system holds the Google credentials and is the only thing permitted to write. Nothing else can reach the account, by construction.
- **The owner can revoke at any time**, from their own Google account, without asking us. The connection stops working immediately.